

Esade Business School

Template for first 6SA (Six Sentence Argument) Assignment

(Individual)

Business in Society Fall 2025

MSc in Business Analytics

6SA Assignment Project Maven

This 6SA Assignment requires two readings. The [Google Project Maven case](#) for the empirical context and the [Four-Questions-Framework](#) reading for theoretical background.

The steps for this assignment (as presented in class) are:

- 1) Do readings (Google case and Four-Questions-Framework)
- 2) Decide quickly what your position is if you were an employee: Would you sign the letter to Sundar Pichai to stop Project Maven at Google? Why or why not? → Document your decision below (A. below)
- 3) Review structure and examples of 6SA (review Session 6 slides 33-43 and optionally 6SA manual <https://wp-prd.let.ethz.ch/WP0-CIPRF9688/>)
- 4) Sketch out your 6SA using your OWN thinking → Using the template B. below
- 5) Test the 6SA with genAI → Document how your thinking is changing, C. below
- 6) Improve and finalize the 6SA → Using the template D. below

Please fill in the following fields A.-D. below to complete the assignment:

A. What is your decision from step 2) and the key reason (Would you sign the letter to Sundar Pichai to stop Project Maven at Google? WHY?)

Yes, I would totally sign the letter without hesitation. Google getting involved in Project Maven feels like a straight-up betrayal of what the company is supposed to stand for. You cannot go around saying “Don’t be evil” while training AI that makes military drones better at tracking targets. That’s not innovation, that’s helping build war tech and pretending it’s progress.

it's true, that you could argue that more accurate AI might help avoid human mistakes and save civilian lives. But honestly, that’s a dangerous illusion; because there’s no real way to control or be transparent about how the military will actually use that technology. Once Google hands over the system, it loses any moral control over what happens next.

Hiding behind the “non-offensive use” excuse is pure corporate hypocrisy. Every line of code written for this project could end up being part of an automated decision that costs real human lives. If Google can’t guarantee that its technology won’t be misused, then it should say no.

Moreover, Google doesn’t need the Pentagon’s money; it needs to protect its values. People join Google because they believe technology can make the world better, not because they want to make killing more efficient. Continuing with Project Maven basically turns engineers into unwilling accomplices.

B. Your first sketch of the 6SA (WITH YOUR OWN thinking, not using GenAi, not even for wording/grammar)

6SA structure	FILL IN: YOUR sentence	FILL IN: Word count of each sentence (max 20 words)
#1 Introduction	Google’s Project Maven shows a clear line-crossing moment where technology turns from innovation to complicity in war	17
#2 Position	I would absolutely sign the letter because building AI for drones goes against everything Google claims to stand for.	19
#3 Reason	You can’t preach “Don’t Be Evil” while teaching machines how to track people for the military.	16
#4 Challenge	Some say smarter AI could make strikes more accurate and save civilian lives.	13
#5 Rebuttal	That’s a dangerous illusion, in reality there’s zero real control or transparency once the military gets the tech.	18
#6 Conclusion	Refusing Project Maven is about protecting human values before profit turns innovation into another weapon.	15

C. After having tested the logic and strength of argument of your 6SA with genAI, document how your thinking is evolving. What changes are you making to your first draft and why?

Yes, I would still sign the letter to stop Project Maven. I believe Google's involvement in a military AI project represents a serious moral contradiction with the company's values and public mission. You cannot claim to "Do the Right Thing" while developing algorithms that could help drones identify and target people more effectively. That is not innovation; it is crossing an ethical line and disguising it as progress.

However, I now recognize that the issue is more complex than I initially thought. Some argue that advanced AI can help make warfare more precise and potentially save civilian lives. Others suggest that if responsible companies like Google refuse to cooperate with democratic governments, the military will turn to other contractors that might have no ethical standards at all. There is also a legitimate concern that by stepping away from defense projects, democratic countries could fall technologically behind authoritarian regimes that are aggressively developing military AI, which could destabilize the global balance of power.

Even though I understand these arguments, I still believe that the lack of transparency and ethical control makes such collaboration incompatible with Google's core principles. Once the technology leaves the company's hands, oversight disappears, and moral responsibility fades. For Google, protecting its integrity and ensuring its technology is used for the public good should outweigh any short-term strategic or political advantage. I reckon, true innovation must serve humanity, not militarize it.

Reflection:

After testing my 6SA with GenAI, my core position didn't change. I would still sign the letter, but my reasoning and understanding of the situation definitely evolved. At first, my argument was pure outrage at Google's hypocrisy. It felt right emotionally, but not fully thought through.

At first, I only focused on defending why I would sign the letter, but now I also understand the importance of asking why not? Exploring that side has helped me see that the issue is not simply about being for or against the project, but about the broader consequences that both decisions could create.

Although I still disagree, considering the opposing perspectives has made my position clearer and more mature. I still believe that signing the letter is the right decision, but now I can defend it not only through emotion, but with a more thoughtful, balanced argument and a broader vision.

D. Your FINAL sketch of the 6SA (after the test with genAI)

6SA structure	FILL IN: YOUR sentence	FILL IN: Word count of each sentence (max 20 words)
#1 Introduction	Project Maven exposes the ethical tension between technological innovation and the potential militarization of artificial intelligence.	16
#2 Position	I would sign the letter to stop the project, as Google's military involvement contradicts its values and mission.	18
#3 Reason	Creating algorithms that help drones identify and target people crosses a moral line.	13
#4 Challenge	Some argue cooperation is necessary to strengthen democratic nations and prevent authoritarian regimes from dominating military AI development.	18
#5 Rebuttal	Yet ethical influence disappears once control and transparency are lost, making real accountability impossible despite geopolitical concerns.	17
#6 Conclusion	True innovation must protect humanity's values; technological progress means nothing if it deepens conflict or fuels global instability.	18